



Libby Story

Employee Operations

Manual

"Where Fashion is Art."

100 – WELCOME TO LIBBY STORY

The McRight Family and the entire management team are excited to have you as part of our operations. We are extremely proud of all of our stores and are anxious to show Ridgeland and the surrounding community the best experience in fashion and customer service available. We will strive at all time to surpass the expectations of our customers, and the requirements of our clients. Please remember that the more successful we become as a whole, the more successful you become as an individual.

At Libby Story, we are fashion lovers, vintage seekers, craft makers, hard workers, and most of all—individuals. Libby Story is all about the unique, creative spirit in each of us. Our mission at Libby Story is to provide apparel, accessories, décor and service in such a way that each customer feels their purchases were tailor made for them. We provide small batch-runs, one-of-a-kind and vintage items to ensure our customers can build and express their creativity and individuality with our products. We also emphasize creativity in our stores and on our website through art, DIYs, crafts, and unique displays to provide an inspiring environment for our guests to enjoy. Our mission is recognized from the moment a customer enters our stores. Our customer's experience is one of inspiration, excitement, fun, happiness, professionalism and warmth. It is our goal that each of our customers leaves feeling inspired, loved, needed, and appreciated. We are determined to attain this level of service, and we can only reach such a goal with 100% of our employees working in harmony together.

101 History

Libby Story was established in 2004 by Libby and her husband, John Hunter McRight. Libby Story, Libby's maiden name, has become synonymous with creativity and style. It all started in Greenville, MS (the heart of the Mississippi Delta) when Libby was only 16 years old. She began working at a women's retail store called "Gail's." She soon realized that she was destined to work in the fashion industry. She continued to work at Gail's all through high school and during her college breaks from MSU. Libby began going to markets and buying for Gail's when she was 19. When she graduated from college, she was already managing Gail's and had begun designing and wholesaling her own jewelry line to stores throughout Mississippi. However, she was uncertain as to whether she would take one of several department store jobs offered to her in larger cities. Not wanting to sacrifice her creativity, she decided to open her own store.

The first Libby Story opened in Greenville, MS. This is where Libby was raised, and after working for Gail's, this is where she saw the need for a creative and fashion-forward company. Libby's deep connection with her Grandmother and her Grandmother's closet played a large role in Libby's need to merge past and present, to preserve the past, while forging into the future. Libby's charming craftiness, wit, large assortment of unique clothing and accessories, plus her killer handmade jewelry line made the store an instant success. This success made the launch of additional stores across the state a no-brainer. Starkville, MS was the second place the McRights decided to expand their talent to, and then came Ridgeland. After the success of the first Ridgeland location, the McRights decided to expand again and move the flagship Libby Story to a much larger location at the Renaissance. Still constantly and unceasingly crafting, creating, designing, and dreaming, Libby is truly the essence of the Libby Story girl.

Libby Story is owned by the McRight family. John Hunter and Libby are the founders and play an active role in the creative department and overall supervision of Libby Story.

102 The Libby Story Girl

The Libby Story girl is unique and independent. She is creative, hard-working, and has a large imagination. She likes to make things and has no qualms with getting her hands dirty and trying something new. She loves the hunt of finding new, trendy items, as well as items that others might discard or overlook. It is a combination of the two elements that creates her truly unique look.

200 – EMPLOYMENT

Libby Story is only as good as the people that work with us. We acknowledge that our workers are a vital part of our company and a vital part of our customer's experience. Since our humble beginnings, we have built a reputation of being a unique and friendly place to shop, and to continue that reputation, we aim to hire the best and brightest workers. Yes, our expectations are high, but the experience and opportunities are bright.

201 Employee Selection

Libby Story selects its employees through advertising, referrals, word-of-mouth, written application, and by personal interviews and careful reference checking. We interview several candidates prior to selecting those who demonstrate the ability, experience, skills and cooperative spirit that we seek in our employees. Congratulations on making it through the whole process and becoming an employee with our company. We are honored to have you join our team.

202 Sexual Harassment

While all forms of harassment are prohibited, Libby Story has an explicit policy prohibiting the sexual harassment of its employees. Specifically, sexual harassment means unwelcome sexual advances, requests for sexual favors, and/or other verbal or physical conduct of a sexual nature.

Management has the responsibility to maintain a workplace free of any form of sexual harassment. That means that Management shall not threaten or insinuate, either explicitly or implicitly, that an employee's refusal to submit to sexual advances will adversely affect the employee's employment, evaluation, wages, advancement, assigned duties, shifts, or any other condition of employment or career development.

If you believe that the actions or words of a customer, delivery person, Manager or fellow employee constitute unwelcome sexual harassment, you have a responsibility to report that behavior to your Manager immediately. All complaints of harassment will be investigated discreetly and promptly. Any employee, supervisor, or manager who, after investigation, is found to have engaged in harassment will be subject to appropriate disciplinary action, up to and including termination.

Any employee who makes management aware of sexual harassment activities will not suffer adverse job consequences as a result of a complaint.

203 Performance Reviews

Performance reviews are administered for new employees during the Orientation Period, and quarterly, or as required, thereafter. Increases in pay are not automatic and are based on merit and productivity.

204 Separation from Employment

Employees who voluntarily resign are required to give a 14-day notice for the training and orientation of a new employee. This assists Libby Story in finding a suitable replacement for you and in maintaining a high level of customer service.

Any employee can be terminated for misconduct, poor performance, or failure to comply with company policies.

Final paychecks are issued on the next scheduled payday, and your final paystub will be mailed to you.

205 Orientation Period

All new employees of Libby Story participate in a 30 day Orientation Period conducted by their Supervisor used to familiarize the employees both with Libby Story and with each other.

The Orientation Period may be extended if necessary.

All employees are reviewed at the end of this time to discuss areas of strength, those needing improvement, and are encouraged to ask any questions. If the employee is unsuited for the assigned job, it is understood they could be reassigned, or terminated, from employment at any time during, or after, the Orientation Period.

206 Full-Time Employees

Full-time hourly non-exempt (non-salaried employees) are classified as employees that regularly work **a minimum of 35 hours per week** and are paid on an hourly basis. Regularly is defined by the average of the prior 26 weeks.

Full-time hourly non-exempt managers (non-salaried employees) are classified as employees that regularly work **a minimum of 38 hours per week** and are paid on an hourly plus commission basis. Regularly is defined by the average of the prior 26 weeks.

Full-time exempt employees (salaried employees) regularly work **a minimum of 40 hours per week** and are paid on a salaried basis. Regularly is defined by the average of the prior 26 weeks.

All full-time employees (salaried and hourly employees) are entitled to all benefits outlined in this Handbook.

207 Part-time Employees

Part-time hourly non-exempt employees are those regularly working less than 35 hours, per week. Regularly is defined by the average of the prior 26 weeks.

Part-time employees are eligible for statutory benefits as outlined in this Handbook. Part time employees are not eligible for paid vacation.

300 – SCHEDULING

301 Hours of Operation

Libby Story hours of operation vary from location to location.

The normal workweek for the Libby Story Ridgeland location is seven days a week, or as dictated by the Renaissance management/customer needs. The hours you work may be changed to adjust for management or customer needs. Libby Story Ridgeland normal hours of operations are:

- Monday – Thursday: 10 AM to 7 PM
- Friday – Saturday: 10 AM to 8 PM
- Sunday: 1 PM to 6 PM
- Holiday Hours (Christmas season) Monday - Saturday: 9 AM to 9 PM
- The only hours the Renaissance observes are Easter, Thanksgiving Day and Christmas Day. Expect to be open normal store hours on any given holiday other than those we are closed.

The normal workweek for the Libby Story Starkville location is six days a week, or as dictated by the owners/management. The hours you work may be changed to adjust for management or customer needs. Libby Story Starkville normal hours of operations are:

- Monday – Friday: 10 AM to 6 PM
- Saturday: 10 AM to 5 PM
- Home Game Saturday: 9 AM to 6 PM
- Sunday: Closed except on home football game weekends.
- Home Game Sunday: 11 AM to 3 PM
- The only hours the Starkville store observes are Fourth of July, Easter, Thanksgiving Day, and Christmas Day. Expect to be open normal store hours on any given holiday other than those we are closed.

Libby Story employees are expected to report for their work shifts one hour prior to opening and to stay until the last customer leaves and chores are completed. **Our hours of operations do change during the Christmas holiday shopping season and for certain holidays and special occasions throughout the year.** Expect to be scheduled for any other times around those holidays and occasions.

302 Schedules

All schedules are posted through Google docs online. Each employee must have a gmail account to check your schedule. Be sure to check the schedule every time you work to make sure there are no changes or added staff meetings. Once a schedule is posted, there is no asking for time off. You may swap shifts with another employee with management approval. If you have any questions or concerns, feel free to discuss them with management in person or via email.

Requests for regular time off are handled via email only. Check the Requests Off tab on your schedule for “Black Out” dates before making a request for time off. “Black Out” dates are days that no one is allowed off due to store needs, or days that might have been requested off by other employees first. Requests for Paid Time Off are handled via the Libby Story Request Off Form only. This form tracks vacation time used and vacation time available.

Requests for time off are granted on a first come, first serve basis. Please note, a request for time off is simply that...a request, not a guarantee.

303 Meal / Break Periods

All employees who work a shift of more than six hours, receive, and are encouraged to use, their one half (1/2) hour unpaid meal period each day as a break from their daily responsibilities.

All employees on the retail sales floor are not allowed to take meal periods/breaks during the critical customer periods. Meal periods will be scheduled and approved by management each work shift.

304 Overtime

Depending on Libby Story workload, employees may be required to work overtime. Overtime is paid to hourly employees at one and one-half times the regular hourly rate for over forty (40) hours worked in a week.

Management will make every effort to give employees as much notice as possible of necessary overtime. All overtime must be approved by Management prior to its being worked. There will be no unauthorized overtime.

Only hours actually worked will be counted for overtime. Any other paid time such as vacation, holiday time, or bonus time will not count toward overtime calculations.

305 Clocking In / Out

In accordance with Government regulations, all companies are required to record time worked on a daily basis, to compute pay and keep a record of attendance. Lunch periods and breaks must be recorded, along with any time an employee is absent during the day.

The following procedures must be adhered to at all times.

1. All work performed must be while clocked in.
2. Work only those hours posted, following your name on the work schedule. You will be paid only for your scheduled and approved time.
3. Your supervisor must approve any change from the work schedule, including overtime assignments.
4. You must clock in when ready to work at the beginning of each work shift and immediately at the end of each work shift.
5. If, for some reason, you forget to clock in / out, report to a manager or the office.
6. Falsifying or altering a time record; failing to check in or out; or recording or falsifying a time record for another employee is strictly prohibited by law, and can lead to disciplinary action up to and including dismissal for both employees.
7. All employees will be paid at the correct rate of pay. If you have any problem with your pay, contact your Manager immediately.
8. All breaks must be communicated and approved by a manager or supervisor.

306 Staff Meetings

To improve our skills, or learn about new procedures, products, or services, employees will be required to attend all mandatory staff meetings. Staff meetings are typically conducted once per month, and advance notice will be given in most cases. Not attending required staff meetings will result in disciplinary action, up to and including dismissal. Employees will be paid their typical rate of pay for required meetings.

307 Inclement Weather

School and government closings during inclement weather do not equal to Libby Story store closings. In general, if there is inclement weather all employees are to report and/or remain at work unless a manager notifies you differently.

Snow and/or Ice Conditions:

If there is snow and/or ice on the roads, all employees should report for work, unless the manager on duty notifies you personally and tells you differently.

Severe Thunderstorm and/or Tornado Watch:

All Libby Story locations remain open during severe thunderstorms and tornado watches. All employees should report for work and continue to work as usual. You will be notified if there are any changes.

Tornado Warning:

During the event of a tornado warning, all Libby Story locations are to follow this procedure:

1. Notify all customers and employees in the store of the warning.
2. Allow customers a 10 minute window to leave store premises.
3. Lock the store's front and back doors for the remainder of the actual tornado warning.
4. Take cover in a central location free from falling objects and glass. Libby Story Ridgeland employees and/or customers should take cover in the central dressing room area. Libby Story Starkville employees and/or customers should take cover in the dressing room hallway.
5. After the tornado warning is over, unlock all doors and resume business as usual.

NOTE: You will be notified differently if you are to do anything beyond the procedure as outlined above. Do not call the store owners, Headquarters, Renaissance management offices, surrounding stores, or any other managers asking for instructions or if it is okay to close down. During the event of catastrophic damage or injuries, contact 911 for emergency help.

400 – ATTENDANCE

Employees are expected to report to work on time each day to begin work at the assigned time. Each person is very important to the smooth operation of Libby Story. Absence and tardiness can create a hardship for other employees and our customers.

If you will be absent you must personally notify your manager three hours before your scheduled starting time so arrangements can be made for someone else to handle your duties. It is also your responsibility to assist in replacing yourself on the schedule.

Asking a relative, friend or another person to call in for you is not acceptable! Texting or emailing your call in is not acceptable!

Any employee who does not report for work and fails to call in for ANY work shift will have voluntarily resigned from their position.

401 Tardiness

Because of the unfair burden placed on Libby Story's customers and other employees, chronic tardiness is not acceptable and may be cause for disciplinary action, up to and including dismissal. If you are going to be late, you must notify your Manager by phone, not by text message. Call the manager's personal cell phone if you open in the morning, but you know you will be late. **Being tardy more than four times in a 6 month period will result in termination.** After one (1) tardy, you will receive a verbal warning. After two (2) tardies, you will be written up. After three (3) tardies, you will be suspended for two (2) weeks without pay. After four (4) tardies, you will be terminated.

402 Absences

Employees are expected to schedule personal appointments either before or after the workday, or on their scheduled day off whenever possible.

Employees must call their Manager **each day** of absence and indicate the reason for absence unless instructed otherwise. **If you are absent three (3) separate times in a 30-day period, you may be considered unfit for employment with Libby Story, and may be terminated.** Also, full-time employees are expected to not miss more than **ten (10) days** of work during a one year period regardless of vacation time, personal leave, or sick leave.

Employees that miss more than two (2) work shifts should provide a doctor's excuse upon returning to work.

Employees who leave their shift during the workday must notify their manager prior to leaving. If employees know in advance that they will be absent, they must notify their Manager who can approve reasonable absence requests.

403 Unexcused Absences

Any employee who fails to report for work, or call in, for ANY work shift, will have voluntarily resigned their position. All other absences from work are considered unexcused and will result in disciplinary action.

500 – COMPENSATION

501 Pay Period

All employees are paid on a bi-monthly basis each Friday for the hours worked for the two (2) previous weeks from Sunday through Saturday. Any commission checks will be paid on the first pay day of each new month.

Your rate of pay is **CONFIDENTIAL**, and should not be discussed with other employees. **Violation of this policy will be cause for termination.** Any discrepancies or questions about your pay should be brought to the immediate attention of your Manager. Libby Story makes every effort to be accurate and will correct errors as quickly as possible.

We rarely handwrite checks for employees. All regular pay checks will be direct deposited to your personal checking account via the information you provided with your initial paperwork. Employees will not receive a paycheck until correct bank and routing information is given to our accountant.

502 Holidays

Libby Story employees are expected to work on any holiday that Libby Story remains open. Any employee that works on the following holidays will be paid at an overtime rate (one and one-half times the regular hourly rate):

- New Year's Day
- Fourth of July
- Labor Day
- Memorial Day

A closed holiday does not count as paid time off hourly employees.

The Owners and the Renaissance Management Team reserve the right to schedule special hours open for business or special arrangements, on days normally taken as holidays. Libby Story may operate on all holidays, by accepting a position of employment, you are accepting to be available to work some or all Holidays as the business warrants. Advance notice will be given for all scheduled days.

503 Vacation Policy

Full-time exempt and non-exempt employees (salaried and hourly employees) earn vacation days based on their length of employment with Libby Story, and are eligible after one year of continuous employment.

Length of Employment / Total Days Earned Per Year:

Less than 1 year	0
After 1 year	5 days
After 3 years	10 days

Vacation time cannot be taken during the store's peak season and is subject to management approval. Also, full-time employees are expected to not miss more than ten (10) days of work during a one year period regardless of vacation time, personal leave, or sick leave.

504 Employee Discount Policy

Employees do receive an employee discount on all Libby Story purchases. All current part-time employees receive a 20% discount, and all current full-time employees receive a 30% discount. Libby Story models are classified as part-time employees and receive a 20% discount. Employee and model discounts cannot be taken on sale items. All employees receive an EXTRA 50% off sale merchandise.

Family members and friends are not allowed to use your employee discount, and the employee must be present when using the discount. Also, employees are not allowed to check themselves out. A member of the management team must check out employees and models.

Anyone found abusing their employee discount will forfeit this privilege and/or may be dismissed from employment.

601 Accident Plan

In case of an accident, **STOP WORK**, and take the following steps:

1. Eliminate the cause of the accident to prevent further injuries.
1. Provide aid to the Injured person. If the Injury appears serious dial 911.
2. Get a Manager **Immediately**, or call an owner if the manager is hurt.
3. Take steps to prevent further accidents.
4. Prepare a written accident report with the full details of the accident and submit it to Management on the day of the accident.

FAILURE TO FOLLOW SAFETY RULES AND PROCEDURES WILL LEAD TO DISCIPLINARY ACTION, UP TO DISCHARGE FROM EMPLOYMENT!

To protect all employees and to safeguard equipment and property, it is our policy that no employee will perform any type of work until they fully understand the correct operation and possible hazards involved, safety procedures, and the necessity of safety equipment. Accidents can be prevented through use of reasonable precautions and the practice of safe working habits.

602 Work Area Maintenance

A safe, pleasant and efficient work environment is a constant concern of Libby Story. Safety of our employees and customers is a vital consideration. It is recognized that safety and good housekeeping are a necessary part of everyone's daily activity. Every employee should allow time to clean up and finish daily chores before leaving for the day.

The entire sales staff also has the responsibility of maintaining the highest standards of cleanliness and sanitation. It is important to remember that we are dealing with the public, and they expect and deserve strict standards of cleanliness. As an employee you will be expected to:

- No food or drinks are allowed in back room where merchandise is checked in and steamed.
- Clean up all food/drink spills throughout the store immediately.
- Properly care for clothing and merchandise at all times.
- Take special precaution transporting merchandise throughout the store.
- Walk, don't run.
- Exercise caution around the dumpster outside.
- Exercise caution regarding the materials being placed in the dumpster, and the amount and weight of the materials being dumped. Be careful not to injure your back.
- Do not sit on any tables, countertops, and/or displays throughout the front and back of the store.
- Exercise caution when moving displays, mannequins, packages, etc. Be careful not to injure yourself.

603 Building Security

The building is protected by a video surveillance system and the Renaissance security staff. The employee entrance door must remain locked during any time that the store is closed. Both the front and back doors of the store must remain locked (top & bottom locks) during any time that the store is closed. Failure to do so may result in immediate termination.

604 Visitors

All visitors must report to Management and be escorted within the facility. Visitors are not allowed in the back of the store without a manager.

605 Personal Belongings and Tools

Please do not bring any personal belongings to the facility, office, vehicles or back of the store. Personal belongings should be left in your car or at home. The company is not responsible for lost or stolen items.

606 Company Property/Inventory

The purpose of all Company property is for the smooth operation of our daily responsibilities. All equipment must be used appropriately, handled carefully, and kept in good condition.

Employees are not to remove Company property unless authorized by The Management. Unauthorized removal of any supplies, property, or products will lead to termination.

607 Theft

If you see or suspect that a customer, employee, delivery person, visitor or anyone else has taken anything belonging to Libby Story or its employees, notify the Owners or management immediately. Take the time to study what the person looks like, physical characteristics or any other formal identification. If possible, take their picture, get their tag number, and try to take a picture of the getaway car. Document significant information and the approximate time on the surveillance system that contains video footage. The shoplifter will be prosecuted to the full extent of the law.

There are several methods of theft prevention you can use in order to prevent shoplifting.

- Notice the shoplifter. Someone who might be shoplifter is someone who you notice looking at the register and the workers. A shoplifter might have a larger purse, bag, or baby stroller. A shoplifter might be rude and guarded, often times not wanting help.
- Stand close enough to customers to keep an eye on what they're doing. If you suspect someone is shoplifting, get a little closer. Make conversation with them and keep tagging along with them talking about merchandise and taking any merchandise out of their hands. This will most likely make the shoplifter uncomfortable, and they will leave before any damage is done.
- Make sure all merchandise is security sensed. Check in dressing rooms and hidden corners around the store for hidden sensors and tags. Check in the pockets of clothing, purses, décor, etc. for hidden merchandise, tags, or sensors.
- Always check on your customers in the dressing rooms. Let them know that you know what they have in there with them. Ask if their sizes are working, do they need anything else, etc.
- If the alarm at the doors beeps, always check to see who it is/what is going on.
- You may check Libby Story bags, but you may not check personal bags.

608 Off-Duty Employees

Off-duty employees are not allowed in the back of the store or offices once their shift has ended. An off-duty employee will be subject to disciplinary action if they are caught hanging around and/or distracting on-duty employees.

609 Restricted Areas

The administrative offices of Libby Story are restricted in all facilities, to employees, unless authorized by Management.

610 Bathroom Area

If the bathroom is located in a non-public area, such as in the back offices of a particular Libby Story location, then an employee must accompany a customer to the bathroom and remain in the back with them, if there are no other workers in the area at that time. This is to prevent theft and/or accidents.

Employees must inform the manager on duty if you are stepping off the floor to accompany a customer, or leaving the floor for any reason, so that your area is covered in your absence.

700 – PERSONAL CONDUCT & POLICIES

701 Philosophy of Working Together

An organization such as ours must be governed by certain rules and regulations. Our goal is to be fair and consistent in our policies and to encourage mutual respect among our employees. We encourage open communication and cooperation. We ask employees be part of the solution to our work-related problems, rather than part of the problem. Respecting the rights and privacy of co-workers is an integral part of teamwork. Gossiping about other employees, or discussing the private lives of employees is strongly discouraged. Through teamwork, all employees and Libby Story can be successful.

At Libby Story we believe in the potential of every individual. The success of our company is directly linked to the responsibilities and growth of each member of our team. We believe that hard work produces results and that creativity is good for the soul. We encourage diversity and encourage out-of-the-box thinking and imagination. Diversity can sometimes make working as a team more difficult, but this is a challenge we welcome.

702 Personal Appearance/Clothing

Libby Story takes pride in its employees, facilities and services, and each employee's personal appearance and work habits are expected to contribute to this image. Employees are expected to dress in a neat, clean and professional manner based on job responsibilities.

Appearance is a personal matter and sometimes opinions differ on what is acceptable, but we reserve the right to require employees to conform to acceptable standards of personal presentation and appearance. Libby Story employees are expected to dress like the typical Libby Story girl. Your personal clothing should reflect your personal style and the style of the store.

You must be properly dressed before clocking in to begin your shift. Employees must stay in proper dress until the shift is completed and you punch out.

Sales Staff / Front of House:

1. A sincere, friendly smile.
2. Clean, fashionable clothing that is not too revealing and/or offensive to customers or employees.
3. Clean, neatly trimmed and combed, hair.
4. Clean hands; clean, trimmed fingernails.
5. No excessive makeup, perfume, or cologne.
6. Shoes must be clean and appropriate for your work shift. Keep in mind that you are on your feet the entire work shift. Shoes must be worn at all times while on duty to prevent slipping, falling, or other injury.
7. No offensive tattoos. If your tattoo is offensive, it must be fully covered during your work shift.

Office Personnel-

1. Clean, fashionable, professional attire and look.

YOU ARE ALWAYS JUDGED BY YOUR APPEARANCE, AND YOUR APPEARANCE IS A STATEMENT OF WHO YOU ARE.
At Libby Story, you are encouraged to be creative with your outfits.

703 Personal Use of Company Supplies/Equipment

Employees are not permitted personal use of any Company supplies, such as computers, vehicles, postage, office/cleaning supplies, credit cards, stationary, or equipment used in the operation of Libby Story. The computers are only to be used by the managers, unless you are told otherwise. Never browse the web on Libby Story computers. Never check your personal email, and/or look at social media on company time.

You may use the office refrigerator and break station supplies during your Libby Story work shift.

704 Telephone Use

It is critical that our employees and telephone lines be available to our customers. **Employees are not allowed personal use of our telephones.** Messages for incoming personal calls will be taken and given to you. These should be restricted to emergency calls only.

Personal cell phone use is not allowed while clocked in, and personal cell phones should not be kept on your body. Cell phones should be turned on silent and put away in the cell phone jail once clocked-in. Please wait to check/ use cell phones until you are on break.

705 Gifts/Tips

No Company employee shall accept any type of gifts/tips from vendors or customers without the prior knowledge, and approval, of the owners. Employees offered or receiving such gifts/tips shall refuse them in a polite but firm manner, advising the giver of Libby Story's policy prohibiting its acceptance. Employees must report these situations to a manager. Violation of this policy will result in a disciplinary action, including possible termination.

706 Unauthorized Work

Employees working at Libby Story are expected to perform work only for Libby Story during the workday.

Any employee who performs unauthorized work, claims that Company work has been done when such is not the case, or performs any act of fraud or deceit, will be subject to disciplinary action, including possible termination of employment.

707 Smoking Policy

Cooperation with our smoking policy promotes good health for all employees and customers, and complies with Mississippi State regulations and County Health Codes. Smoking is completely prohibited **anywhere** in or around the buildings, with the only exception being in the designated smoking area outside. Customers wishing to smoke must go outdoors, preferably not in front of the entrances. Sales staff is prohibited from smoking at any time while working with customers. Please do not smoke while in the view of a customer.

This "Smoking area" is the responsibility of the employees who smoke and break there. Failure to keep this area clean may result in one or more of the following consequences; 1. Cleaning the area, 2. Contributing to paying an employee to clean the area, or 3. Revocation of the privilege of using this area.

There is no smoking in Company vehicles.

Employees who violate these policies are in violation of Mississippi State law and our Company policy, and may receive disciplinary action up to and including discharge.

708 Confidentiality

As an employee of Libby Story you may not discuss, photocopy, duplicate, e-mail, or reveal customers or any information in any form to anyone outside Libby Story. Information obtained as a result of your employment with Libby Story and contact with our customers can only be used in the course of your employment with us. This information is considered proprietary. Any unauthorized use, collection, copying, removal, or transfer in any manner of this information may be ground for immediate dismissal from employment, and other legal action.

This policy applies to internal documents and records as well as any information concerning sales, customers, other employees, vendors or suppliers.

709 Parking

Employees are asked to check with their Manager regarding appropriate parking guidelines, and must park in designated employee areas located in the far back lots. Any employee may request and shall receive an escort to their vehicle.

710 Waste Prevention

All employees can help make Libby Story more environmental by conserving resources. Please make extra special efforts to conserve and reuse. Employees are required to inform management of any defective or aging equipment they wish to discard. Only management can make that final decision. Any damaged merchandise must be brought to the attention of a manager and turned in for repair.

711 Financial Procedures

All employees who handle cash, credit card, debit card, store credit, gift card, and/or donation transactions must strictly adhere to Company policies and procedures as directed by the Owners and the Management of Libby Story. These procedures will be explained to you in detail by your supervisor.

Failure to follow any financial procedures may lead to disciplinary action, up to and including termination and/or full repayment of lost money.

712 Disciplinary Action

If the need arises to correct a situation in which an employee has violated Company procedure, regulations or policy, oral warnings, written warnings, suspension without pay, or termination of employment may be appropriate, depending on circumstances. Employees, as a condition of employment, are required to acknowledge in writing any written warnings.

In addition to the policies, procedures, rules and regulations in this Handbook, the following, not meant to be all-inclusive, are job related actions that may result in disciplinary action, up to and including immediate discharge:

1. Falsification of any reports or documents, pertaining to absence from work, injuries on the job, claims for benefits provided by Libby Story and required record keeping.
2. Willful abuse, deliberate destruction and/or careless or negligent use of Company property or removal of Company property
3. Threatening, intimidating, coercing or interfering with fellow employees or supervisors
4. Being under the influence of drugs or alcohol
5. Fighting, sleeping, gambling, horseplay or any disorderly or immoral conduct
6. Improper performance of job or failure to perform all duties assigned
7. Changing a customer's receipt or transaction.
8. Leaving work area without permission
9. Refusal to obey instructions of supervisor or any other form of insubordination
10. Habitual tardiness/absence
11. Possession of weapons on Company property
12. Violation of or disregard of financial procedures
13. Violation of or disregard of safety rules or safety practices
14. The absence of three separate times in a thirty-day period
15. Unauthorized absence/failure to notify employer
16. Cash shortage of \$25.00 or more once, or more than \$5.00 twice over a 6 month time period.
17. Stealing or attempting to steal company property or services.

713 General Information

- Employees may not consume alcohol while on duty or within 24 hours before a shift.
- All food and drinks must be kept in the designated break area. No food or drinks are allowed at the POS area or in the stock room where merchandise is checked in.
- You must always inform a manager if you step off the sales floor. We must have at least two (2) people on the sales floor at all times.
- Remember, the Libby Story Philosophy is TEAM WORK. Everything is everyone's job. Help each other out.
- You are the company's biggest and most valuable asset. Thank you for choosing to be a part of our team.

714 Employee Concerns

Our employees are a key element in the success of Libby Story. Employees should attempt to resolve any difficulties with a co-worker at the employee level. If the situation is not resolved, it should be discussed with Management.

800 – GENERAL STORE POLICIES

801 Returns & Exchanges

A customer has seven (7) days to return regular priced merchandise for a full refund and up to 30 days for exchange/store credit. Merchandise cannot be worn or damaged. All tags must be attached, and the customer must have their original, itemized receipt to be eligible for a refund/exchange/store credit. No refunds or exchanges are allowed on sale merchandise. No returns on swimwear or intimates. Let the customer know the return policy at the time of purchase. The Libby Story return and exchange policy is posted at the register and printed on all receipts.

A manager is the only person authorized to do a return/exchange. Be sure to check the date, item numbers, and prices. If a customer inquires about a return, and you are not a manager, you must refer the customer to the manager before okaying the return.

802 Accepted Forms of Payment

At Libby Story, we take the following forms of payment:

- Cash
- Credit & Debit Cards—Visa, Mastercard, Discover, American Express
- Gift Cards—Libby Story, Renaissance, Others (Visa, Mastercard, etc.)
- Libby Story Store Credit—Store credit does not expire.

We do not take checks. No exceptions. You may offer to hold items for a customer if need be, but be sure to follow our normal hold policy.

We do not take credit card payments over the phone or without the card in-store if the purchase is more than \$100 for security reasons. We can invoice customers by email, and they can pay the invoice if needed.

803 Holds

Customers are allowed to hold items until the end of the next business day. (For example, if a customer puts an item on hold at noon on Monday morning, we can hold the item until closing on Tuesday.) There are hold tags at the register that you must complete and tape to the hold items. For multiple items, rubber band the hangers together so the items do not get separated. Hold tags for items not picked up should be placed in the hold tag bin just in case we need to reference these in the future. Hold tags for items that are picked up can be trashed.

Employees and models are not allowed to hold items. No exceptions.

804 Approvals

Since we have a seven (7) day return policy for full refund, we do not allow customers to take merchandise out of the store on approval.

On occasion, advertising representatives visit the store asking Libby Story to participate in photo shoots, editorials, ad campaigns, etc. In this case, we will allow merchandise to go out on approval, but the manager on duty will handle all approvals.

805 Transfers

With multiple locations, we often have to transfer merchandise from one store to another. You might have a customer looking for another color or size in a particular item. You might have a customer that saw another store's social media post and wants that exact item. No matter the case, we are here to sell them whatever item they want, so always offer this service. There are just a few quick steps to follow when transferring merchandise in or out.

- Transfer In (from another store to Ridgeland)

Employees should check the computer system first when customers are inquiring about transferring an item from another location. If the system says the other store has the item, call them to verify the availability while the customer is still in the store. Ask the other location to send the item to your store, and be sure to give them your name and the customer's name. **Transfers In should be entered in the Transfer spreadsheet located in Google docs. You should write the customer's name, phone number, item number, size, and color of the item being transferred. You should also write the date, the store's location sending the transfer, and who you spoke with at the other location.** At the Ridgeland location, we receive transfers every Friday. If the customer needs an item before our typical shipment, let the manager know so other arrangements can be made. A shipping charge may be applied. Once a transfer in item is received, you are to call the customer and let them know their item has arrived. We will only hold unpaid for transfers for two (2) days.

- Transfer Out (from Ridgeland to another store)

Often times, we have to transfer merchandise to another store. Transfer Out forms are located at the register and must be completed anytime an item is transferred out. You should write the date, your name, the customer's name, what date the customer needs the item by, and who you spoke with on this form. Also, **Transfers Out** should be entered in the Transfer spreadsheet located in Google docs. **The store receiving the transfer** should write the customer's name, whom they spoke with, date, item number and description, size, shipped to, shipped from, initials and how they communicated with the other store about the transfer on this spreadsheet. Once an item is transferred out, you do not have to worry about it any longer. As long as you complete the steps outlined above, the other location should be able to take care of the transfer once they receive it. The Starkville location receives shipments almost daily. Check with the Inventory Manager if you have any questions about transfer shipping dates.

806 Special Orders

Some brands allow us to special order single units for customers. You should always get the customer's name, phone number, item number and description, size, and color of the item in question. Turn all this information into the manager.

- **TIP:** Shoes cannot be special ordered. They must be ordered in bulk. If we think we can sell a whole case again, we will reorder the whole case, if available.

The manager will email the special order request to the office manager, and the office manager will let us know if and when we're able to get the item. The manager should call the customer and let them know whether or not we will be able to order the item. The manager should get all payment information from the customer in advance if we are special ordering an item we do not currently stock.

- **TIP:** If we cannot special order an item, make recommendations of similar items we do have available.

When we receive the special order, the manager will call the customer and let them know that we have received their item. If they have not prepaid for the item, let them know that we can only hold until closing the next day (normal hold policy). Be sure to fill out a hold tag so the sales staff knows when the item can go back out on the floor.

807 Customers Awaiting New Shipments

For the most part, we do not know what merchandise is on reorder again. If you have a customer that is interested in particular item that we no longer have available, you can put them on our Customers to Call When We Receive Merchandise list located at the register. Be sure to put the customer's name, phone number, item number and description of item wanted, size, color, the date, and your initials on this sheet.

Be as specific as possible if there is a particular item the customer wants. For example, a customer may want item number 128944 in the Jeffrey Campbell Virgo Wedge size 6. You would include all this information on the list. Sometimes a customer may just want you to call them when we receive a new shipment of spring combat boots. In this instance, you would just put spring combat boots under item # and description. Again, always get the customer's name, phone number, size needed, date, and your initials. This list is looked over every week by the manager, and the manager makes sure these customers are being called at the appropriate times.

808 Repairs

We can repair any merchandise that is damaged by customers on the sales floor, and we can repair damaged merchandise for customers trying to return worn items. Remember, we do not refund/exchange worn merchandise. The merchandise is considered worn if all the original tags are not still attached. All repairs to damaged merchandise are typically free of charge, but it will generally take seven to ten (7-10) days for the repair to be completed and the merchandise to be ready for pick up. Let management know if the customer needs an item back quicker than the typical turnaround time.

Repair forms are located at the register and should be filled out in its entirety and attached to any damaged goods. Always include the date, your full name, item #, color, size, and problem. If the item has already been purchased and/or is waiting to be purchased when fixed, be sure to include the customer's name, phone number, any additional notes, and what date the customer needs the item back. Remove any sensors from items to be repaired and place these items on the Repairs rack in the stock room.

If an item belongs to a customer and is being repaired, you need to take one more step to ensure we do not misplace their item. Fill out the Repair Sheet located at the register with the customer's name, phone number, the item being repaired, the date they dropped it off, and initial who took the item. If the original repair form is lost, we can still contact the customer and let them know when their item is ready. Also, be sure to inform a manager before placing the item on the Repairs rack if the item belongs to a customer. We want the repair to be tended to as quickly as possible.

809 Alterations

There are times when a customer may need a garment altered. We can do alterations, however we typically do not advertise this service. Alterations are an additional charge, and you should always consult with the manager on duty and/or Libby before setting up this service with the customer.

810 Inventory

Inventory for store supplies, shoes, jeans, and basics are done on a weekly basis by the manager/assistant manager. If you notice that we are low on a particular item, let the manager on duty know so that it can be added to the weekly lists.

The Daily Notes Sheet is kept at the register. This sheet has two columns for Store Supplies and Merchandise to Request. The store supplies column is for supplies we're low on, and the merchandise to request column is for merchandise that we're low on or customer requests.

We want everyone to learn the Libby Story style and be on trend with what we need in the store.

811 New Shipments

New shipments should be processed in the back room, not at the sales counter. Try to get merchandise ready for the sales floor as soon as possible. The quicker the merchandise gets on the floor, the sooner the customer can purchase it. Place all merchandise on lace hangers or wooden bottom hangers, steam, sensor, and sticker it before putting merchandise on the sales floor.

General Rules:

- All merchandise should be sensed unless otherwise instructed.
- All merchandise should be sensed on the back or left side through a thick seam to prevent damage (Ex: shirt collars, necklines, back of pants).
- Shoes should have sensors on the left shoe.
- All hangers for a merchandise run should be the same—all lace, all black wooden, all the same size.
- Lace hangers should be in ideal condition—no loose ends, blank spaces, free of filth or damage.
- Stickers should be applied to each garment accordingly (correct item #, size, color), and should be applied after the garment is steamed.
- All tags should be tucked away and out of customer view.
- Any unnecessary tags should be removed.
- The smallest size of each item should be pulled for models/website.
- Model clothing should be steamed and tagged first. Do not sensor model clothing before it is photographed for the website.

NOTE: Customers come first. Sometimes we are too busy on the sales floor to work on new shipments. The manager on duty will let you know when to and/or not to work on new shipments.

812 Crafts

Because Libby Story is known for creativity, we have an array of craft activities that are performed during our slower times. Here is a general list of crafts we keep on hand and the items we use to make the crafts.

- Magazine Sleeves for Jewelry—made from recycled magazine papers.
- Gift Card Holders—made from recycled cardboard and various pieces of fabric.
- Large Jewelry Bags for Gifts—made from recycled cardboard and various pieces of fabric.
- To-Go Hangers for Hanging Garments—made from two plastic hangers hot glued together and wrapped with fabric.
- Bows for Gift Wrapping—made from various pieces of fabric and twine.
- Lace Hangers for Floor—made from wooden hangers wrapped in lace.

813 Gift Wrapping

At Libby Story, we will gift wrap any item for a customer, free of charge. Gift wrapping should be easy and fast, and you will be taught the proper way to wrap a present according to Libby Story guidelines. Below is a general outline for present wrapping:

Always mark out all prices.

Always include a gift receipt.

Wrap the items being wrapped in tissue.

If you are wrapping the items in a bag, always stuff the bag with tissue and tie a bow and a LS tag onto the handle with twine.

If you are wrapping the items in a box, wrap with the appropriate paper, wrap a strand of fabric around the box, and tie a bow and a LS tag to the top.

Libby Story offers a free Customer Loyalty Program to all customers. The purpose of our Customer Loyalty Program is to offer our customers incentives to shop with us and rewards for shopping with us. Perks of the Libby Story Customer Loyalty Program include:

Points for Purchases - For every \$1 spent on regular priced merchandise = 1 point. 500 points = \$25 credit; Customers can save their points to redeem 1000 points = \$50 credit.

First to know about new arrivals and sales.

Special rewards.

No hassle. No cards. Computer keeps track of everything.

Customers should always be looked up by their full name (first and last name). You should always verify the customer's email address, city and phone number attached to customer name to ensure accuracy. You should not search by the customer's phone number, unless it is a last resort situation. Notify the manager on duty of a duplicate customer account. Customer accounts can be merged, if needed.

900 – ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS & CORRESPONDENCE

901 Corrective Discipline Acknowledgement

All employees of Libby Story, as a condition of employment, are required to acknowledge, in writing, any written warnings. Refusal to acknowledge the receipt of a written warning may result in termination for misconduct.

902 Memos/Bulletin Board

A Bulletin Board is available for communicating information to employees in each facility. Please check the Bulletin Board frequently to keep informed on changes in Company matters and other items of interest. No memos or announcements can be posted without prior approval of the Management.

Periodically, memos are distributed to communicate general information or a change in Company policy or procedure. If you have not received a memo distributed to other employees, please contact the Management. Memos distributed by paycheck are considered received by the staff.

Often times, daily matters and schedule changes are sent via email. All sales staff members should have a Libby Story gmail account that they check on daily basis.

903 Adverse Correspondence

Any memos, fax messages, letters, telegrams, legal notices, summons, or other forms of business communication of a negative nature addressed to any employee of Libby Story, are to be immediately given to Management.

Employees receiving complaints of unfair treatment, customer dissatisfaction, expressions of distress, and all legal documents, are to notify Management who will act upon them immediately.

904 Suggestions

Giving and receiving feedback is encouraged in order to promote a positive, productive and cooperative atmosphere. Employees should use the staff meetings for any suggestions that may be valuable to our productivity and our success. All suggestions will be carefully reviewed and implemented if possible. You may also submit your comments and suggestions via Email to Management using the Libby Story Ridgeland email address: Ridgeland@LibbyStory.com.

905 Public Relations

The courteous, professional treatment of the public by all employees helps to build a loyal base of customers for our company.

Courtesy to our customers, and co-workers; is the least costly of all the services we perform, yet the most rewarding. Whether in person or on the phone, YOU represent Libby Story to our customers and to the public and community at large. We ask that all employees make every effort to represent Libby Story in a polite and professional image. Only designated Management can discuss the affairs of Libby Story with the press (TV, radio, newspapers, bloggers, etc.).

1000 – CUSTOMER SERVICE

In general, we have mentioned benefits, procedures and responsibilities. Now, we need to emphasize the most important component, that is, our customers. As you know, we are able to prosper as a result of our customers.

Libby Story exists because each year, a great many people invest their money, time, and faith in all of us. We must always remember that the person we all work for is **The CUSTOMER**.

The CUSTOMER is not an interruption to our business, the CUSTOMER IS our business!

In order to retain these CUSTOMERS, we want to assure that our excellent reputation continues by always giving the best CUSTOMER service. Working together cooperatively toward this goal provides us with a secure future and with our most important commodity, **a good reputation**. We are in a very competitive business and depend on a loyal base of CUSTOMERS in order to be successful.

1001 What is Customer Service?

Customer service is the provision of service to customers before, during and after a purchase. Customer service is a series of activities designed to enhance the level of customer satisfaction – that is, the feeling that a product or service has met the customer expectation.

1002 Customer Profiles

At Libby Story, we keep tabs on our customers by creating a Customer Profile on individual customers. The Customer Profile binder is located at the register and is divided up by sales associates. **It is your responsibility to develop Customer Profiles on your customers.** Try to complete the form in its entirety.

- Always get your customer's name and phone number.
- What styles and trends does your customer like?
- What styles and trends look best on your customer?
- What size dress, shirt, pants, shoes, etc. does your customer wear?

These are all questions that should be answered when developing Customer Profiles. You can use these profiles to reference back to past purchases, for upcoming store events and promotions, or just to call and say hello. In many instances, these profiles are very handy. The more customers your build relationships with, the more profiles you will develop. **This is a key role in maintaining customer relationships.**

1003 Thank You Cards

Again, at Libby Story we try to enhance our customer service experience and take the extra step in letting our customers know we appreciate their business. You may send out a thank you card to any customer that you enjoyed working with or if you had a special connection with a customer. Also, we require thank you cards to go out for the following purchase amounts:

- \$100-\$199 = 10% off one item
- \$200-\$299 = 15% off one item
- \$300-\$399 = 20% off one item
- \$400> = 25% off one item

You can follow this general template for writing thank you cards, however, thank you cards should be as personable as possible.

"Thank you for shopping with us at LS. I hope you enjoyed your time in the store and love your new purchases. Please bring this card in for ____% off one item of your choice. I hope to see you again soon!"

Sincerely,
_____,"

Thank you cards do not expire and cannot be combined with sale items or additional promotions. Customers must present the thank you card at the time of check out in order to use it. We cannot give the discount without the card. Thank you cards that have been redeemed should be put under the cash till and are included in part of our daily drawer reconciliation process.

1100 – ONLINE PRESCENCE

We encourage Libby Story employees to follow us online and on all social media outlets. This helps you keep up with new arrivals, upcoming events and promotions, what's trending, and help customers with questions they may have about what they saw online. Also, it's a great inspiration for styling and outfitting customers.

1101 LibbyStory.com

LibbyStory.com houses our online store where our customers can shop from home at their convenience. You can always find our latest lookbook, new arrivals, sale items, and generally anything we offer in the store on our website. LibbyStory.com is also home for our blog, which is where we post about our ideas, musings, crafts and occasionally about our awesome products.

All inventory from both Libby Story stores is available at LibbyStory.com. We offer free shipping everyday on orders \$75 and above. All items available online are photographed at the Ridgeland store by an in-house photographer. Libby Story has a full staff of models that we hand-pick for our photo sessions and website pictures. Model auditions are held seasonally (fall and summer), and all model inquiries should be forwarded to the Creative Director.

1102 Social Media

Libby Story has a main Facebook page for the company followed by additional pages for each separate location. We use Facebook to post new arrivals, styled outfits, sales, events, styling competitions, customer appreciation, and more. All our Libby Story Facebook pages post things daily to keep our customers updated on what's going on in our stores.

Libby Story also has an Instagram account for which we use to promote new arrivals, styled outfits, sales, events, styling competitions, customer appreciation, and more. Both store locations have separate Instagram accounts, and each store manages on their own. Our Instagram handles are as follows:

- Libby Story - @thelibbystory
- Libby Story Ridgealnd - @libbystoryridgeland
- Libby Story Starkville - @libbystorystarkville

Again, Instagram is used to keep our customers updated on what's going on in our stores and what merchandise each location carries.

Libby Story also has a Twitter account, yet we are not big tweeters. We use Twitter more as an advertising tool to connect with our customers. Basically, our customers tweet about us.

Libby Story has a Snapchat account too. The account name is @thelibbystory, and the Headquarters location posts to Snapchat on behalf of the entire company.

All social media accounts are handled by store managers and designated staff members only. Employees do not respond or post on Libby Story social media accounts without the permission of the manager on duty.

1103 InstaShop

Customers can sign up for InstaShop by visiting www.InstaShop.LibbyStory.com. This service allows customer to securely store their credit card information online and shop directly from our social media accounts. To purchase an item, the customer literally comments Ship or Pick-Up with the color and size of the item they want to purchase. It's that easy!

Always ask customers if they follow us on social media and encourage customers to sign up for InstaShop. Give them a promotional flyer with instructions. We sell out of items on social media fast so that's a good incentive to get customers interested.



Libby Story

General Employee Orientation

STYLE AUTHENTIC

Thank you for taking the time to review this Handbook. If you have any questions, suggestions, or concerns, please contact the management.

This Libby Story Employee Handbook is and will always be the property of Libby Story. If you leave the employment of Libby Story for any reason, you must return this Employee Handbook to Libby Story.

☐ General employee orientation, completed.

Thank you for continuing on in our hiring & training process.

Employee Name: _____ Date: _____

Manager Conducting Orientation: _____